

Resilience & Growth Mindset

How you deal with setbacks and mistakes determines how far you go. A growth mindset isn't innate — you can train it.

🕒 40 minutes

 **Group + individual**

3 exercises

Evidence-based



What will you take with you today?

01

You distinguish a **fixed mindset response** from a growth mindset response in yourself.

02

You rewrite at least one **negative self-thought** into a learning-focused formulation.

03

You name **three concrete ways** you've grown this season — compared to yourself.

Burnette et al. (2013) — meta-analysis of 113 studies: growth mindset correlates with learning goals, less helplessness after failure and better performance, strongest in adolescents. *Psychological Bulletin*.

Meijen et al. (2020) — review of resilience interventions: cognitive reframing (rewriting thoughts) is the most evidence-based strategy for resilience in young athletes. *Frontiers in Psychology*.

Martin & Marsh (2009) — 2-year follow-up with 3,500 students: academic resilience (persisting after setback) predicts long-term success better than IQ. Replicable in sport.

3

My Hardest Moment

Honestly describe the hardest moment of this season. This may stay private — sharing is voluntary.

What did this moment teach you? How did you come out stronger — as an athlete and a person?

Timing: Month 6 often falls in the toughest part of the season — fatigue, motivation dip. This theme is deliberately placed here as an energy boost.

Michael Jordan — 6x NBA Champion

Tips for this session



Tip 1 — Change your language



Tip 2 — Fixed ritual

Use the Progress List at the start of each monthly session. Players who see growth are steadier in tough times.



Tip 3—Energy boost

Month 6 often falls in the toughest part of the season. Use this theme deliberately as a reorientation and energy boost.



Careful: 'just try harder'

Growth mindset must not mask lack of support. 'Just try harder' isn't enough.
Combine it with concrete tools.

40-minute session

8' min Introduce fixed vs. growth mindset

10' Fill in worksheet individually
min

10' Group reflection on rewritten mistakes

7' Progress List and closing

Stronger through setback.

Today you learned that a mistake is not an endpoint, but a starting point to grow.

⚡ TEAM RITUAL - I TAKE WITH ME...

 I take with me...

Each player says in maximum 5 words what they take from this session. Start yourself. Short and powerful — no explanation needed.

NEXT MONTH → LEADERSHIP FROM WITHIN

Ask players to consciously take one leadership moment this month. Next month: Leadership from Within.